

KEY TAKEAWAY

Mal is a **licensed financial institution first**, **AI-native second**, and **Shariah-compliant third**. We do not believe in user personas — we have targets, but we serve everyone. The only moat is **user-base and distribution**; everything else is replicable. 90% of revenue will come from lending post-licence. Every marketing activity must tie to a growth metric and contribute at least 20% to growth.

1. STRATEGIC CLARITY — POSITIONING & TARGET

BRAND POSITIONING (PRIORITY ORDER)

P0 — LEAD

Financial Institution

Full bank with a licence. New generation banking — not competing with traditional banks.

P1 — DIFFERENTIATOR

AI-Native

Open an account in 30 seconds. Built for speed. AI-native = global by default.

P2 — TRUST LAYER

Shariah-Compliant

The cherry on top. A differentiator, not a defensible moat alone.

LAUNCH CUSTOMERS

No **user personas**. We have targets, but serve everyone.

UAE Retail Tech-savvy customers **UAE SMEs** Offline approach by Mal team (Isham) **Global** USD earners (PK, EG) wanting fast, low-cost payouts

COMPETITIVE MOAT

"The only moat is user-base; everything else is replicable." The stack: **Retail + SME + Lending combined**. FAB = no lending. Wio = tiny SMEs. EFG = lender not bank. **Mal = bank + lender. One-stop shop.**

Gap: We don't yet have a claim only Mal can make. Need quantitative flex, not generic positioning. E.g. "You just transferred money in 2 seconds. Will your other bank do this?"

2. PRODUCT READINESS & ROADMAP

WHAT'S BUILT VS PLANNED

SME Core banking infra built; cards in progress → **live mid-end Jul**
Retail Cards, accounts, PFM built; in testing → **live beginning Jul**

LAUNCH PRIORITY

Global Accounts + PFM first. USD IBAN, card, local-currency payouts. Pakistan = initial target. Vanilla products → quick wins → build user base before full licence.

REVENUE MODEL

90% revenue = lending/financing (IVF, scholarships, auto loans, invoice factoring) — kicks in after CBUAE licence. SME lending can be promoted as of Jul. Not ready to lend yet — ready to build a lending pipeline.

PHASE	PRODUCTS	TIMELINE
Block 0	Cards, Accounts, PFM	Jul 2026 (Launch)
Shortly After	Credit Cards → Lending (student loans, auto loans)	Post-launch
Regulated	Full lending, expanded products	Post CBUAE licence
Stablecoin	Stablecoin cards, remittances (Rain.xyz model)	3–6 months post-launch

AI PERSONAL BANKER

Live product — not a concept.

Key dates: Licence target Sep 1 → Launch event Oct 10 → Fallback: announce Nov 1 or shift event to Nov 11.

3. REGULATORY CONSTRAINTS

LICENCE PATH

Full licence target: October

Application submission: end of August

Other licences in application: ADGM Category 2 (money services; USD lending to SMEs) — not for public disclosure

IPA CONSTRAINTS

AED only (not USD) · UAE residents only for certain activities · Asset limitations

WHAT CAN BE SAID PUBLICLY

CBUAE scope = UAE only. Always "**Mal**" not "**Mal Bank**" externally. **AAS = main POC for public affairs** (disclaimer to regulators). Global Accounts positioning → check with Loay.

SHARIAH BOARD

2 of 3 members appointed. **Not named internally or externally yet.**

STABLECOIN / CROSS-BORDER MORTGAGE

Not reviewed as part of IPA process.

4. DISTRIBUTION & PARTNERSHIPS

Key principle: A partner ≠ a client. ADNOC = client, not partner. Labelling them a partner closes doors elsewhere.

ENTITY	STATUS	NEXT STEP
EDGE	Most advanced	NDA signed, flows scoped → commercials + MOU
Noon	Early	Custom approach per framework
Mubadala	Early	Custom approach per framework
ADNOC	Client, not partner	Treat as client relationship

APPROACH FRAMEWORK

Each relationship needs a custom approach: "**What is the biggest gap Mal can fill for them?**"

COMPETITORS AS CONTEXT

PLAYER	POSITIONING	GAP
FAB	Large SME accounts	No lending
Wio	Tiny SMEs	Limited scope
EFG	Lender	Not a bank
Mal	Bank + Lender	One-stop shop

5. MY MANDATE & RESOURCES

SUCCESS AT 3 MONTHS

Brand & Comms **do not own growth** — Growth owns user base, economics, retention. Every activity must tie to a growth metric and contribute **at least 20%**.

FOCUS AREAS — NEXT 3 MONTHS

Social metrics (beat Wio, benchmark Revolut) Roadmap to 1M followers

Social web: owned media, influencers, events Brand DNA: TOV, architecture, audience

Events & sponsorships Partnership amplification (McKinsey, ecosystem) Minimum dollar spend

BUDGET & HIRING

Budget: Speak to Amine (growth budget ≠ brand budget)

Hiring: Speak to Sama (headcount + compensation bands)

Final approval: AAS has final sign-off on brand & comms

Open items:

- AAS to share brand & comms metrics draft
- Manar to push own draft in the meantime
- Walid to produce benchmarks report (Revolut, NSave, Wio at comparable stage)
- Schedule product demos between Manar and all leads
- Global Accounts public positioning — check with Loay